HMI NATIONALLY ACCREDITED COLLEGE OF HYPNOTHERAPY

INTEGRATING MIND, BODY AND SPIRIT

Workbook – Lesson
Emotional Freedom Technique

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201-14 – Emotional Freedom Technique

Presented By: Susie Kappas, CCHt

Certified EFT Trainer Susie Kappas, CHt, introduces Emotional Freedom Technique (EFT) and how to use it as an extraordinary addition to your hypnotherapy practice. EFT is like acupressure for the emotions. It uses gentle tapping on the body's energy meridians while tuned into an issue. It balances your energy around that issue and releases negative thoughts, events, pain, fear, stress, cravings, and so much more.

Completed: Mon, Aug 25, 2025 / Score: 100%

Workbook - Emotional Freedom Technique

Learning Objectives

As you complete this learning area, you should be proficient in the following areas:

Knowledge

- Understand the basis and basics of Emotional Freedom Technique (EFT).
- The Basic Recipe – The Set-up, Sequence of Points, and Gamut Procedure.

Comprehension

- Basic EFT techniques and how to apply them in therapy.

Application

- To use these techniques with yourself, family, friends, and clients to clear that which is triggering or blocking them or yourself from feeling more peace, joy, and freedom.

Learning Approach

The recommended approach to learning is to:

- Refer to the Workbook for this lesson while watching the lecture, taking notes as needed.
- Review your notes, Workbook pages, and class streaming videos.
- Complete the open-book quiz.
- Practice the techniques covered in this class.

Resources

- Your Class Lecture
- Workbook and Notes
- Suggested Reading
- Supplemental Videos

Workbook Table of Contents

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Overview

Emotional Freedom Technique (EFT) is a gentle yet powerful technique that can be learned by anyone. It is easy, efficient, and very effective. You can use it on yourself, your loved ones, and clients to decrease or eliminate stress, trauma, triggers, unwanted emotions, negative beliefs, fears, habits, cravings, and so much more. With EFT we can clear away that which is not wanted so we can attract those things we do want in our lives. When we have a tool that can easily clear away the negative, we can begin to create our future with more fun, joy, happiness, and freedom.

EFT has also been very successful in helping issues such as weight loss, anxiety, sadness, depression, physical pain, anger, jealousy, phobias, low self-esteem, sports performance, headaches, chronic fatigue, and many, many more.

The reason I'm passionate about and teach EFT is because it has made huge positive changes in my life and my health. I have also witnessed profound positive results in using EFT with my clients since my internship here at HMI in 2004. You will find that this simple technique is well worth incorporating into your hypnotherapy practice. I have seen highly charged issues and triggers collapse in one session that would literally take years in traditional therapy.

Our Body's Energy System

EFT works with the body's energy system. We are made up of energy. Every cell in our body moves and functions with energy. This electrical system, the subtle energy that runs through the body, is carried through tiny pathways called meridians. The same meridians they use in acupressure or acupuncture. The Chinese discovered this vital energy 5,000 years ago, and they call it Chi or Ki. It flows through every part of our body and is necessary to our life force. The medical profession, as well, acknowledges the body's electrical system and can use devices to measure and monitor it. For example, the EEG records the electrical activity of the brain, and the EKG records the electrical activity of the heart.

They are finding that working with this energy system is the *"missing link"* when treating negative emotions. When we have a distressing memory or thought, it actually disrupts our energy system, causing the negative emotion.

I'll repeat that…

They are finding that working with this energy system is the *"missing link"* when treating negative emotions. When we have a distressing memory or thought, it actually disrupts our energy system, causing the negative emotion.

What Exactly is EFT?

EFT is a method of tapping with the fingertips at the end-points of the body's energy meridians *while* tuned into a problem or an issue. In doing so, we balance the energy disruption that continues to trigger the problem. It gets to the core of the issue, *the energy disruption*, and fixes it. In other words, you no longer have a negative emotional charge on that issue. Instead, the energy can flow properly and balanced when tuned-into an issue or trigger. It is exciting to see this process day after day in my practice. Fears, traumas, limiting beliefs, cravings, etc., just simply go away. I wouldn't believe it or be teaching it if I hadn't seen it work over and over on myself and my clients.

EFT works on the theory that our unresolved negative emotions are major contributors to most physical pains, disease, and anxiety. And the cause of all negative emotions is a disruption in the body's energy system.

Discovered by Accident

What is now known as EFT was discovered purely by accident. It was discovered and developed by a psychologist by the name of Dr. Roger Callahan in 1980 in Southern California. He had a patient, who we'll call Mary, who suffered with intense water phobia, related nightmares, and frequent headaches. She'd seen many therapists before him for years. After seeing Dr. Callahan for a year and a half, using conventional methods of therapy, she was still suffering as she had in the past. So, Dr. Callahan decided to go beyond the confines of normal psychotherapy.

Dr. Callahan had been studying the body's energy system, and one day while in therapy, Mary complained about her stomach hurting. Dr. Callahan decided to tap with his fingertips under her eyes, which is an end-point to the stomach meridian. To his astonishment, her water phobia went away immediately. She went down to a nearby pool and threw water in her face with no fear! It was gone. Her associated nightmares and headaches went away as well and have never returned. Needless to say, this made a huge impression on Dr. Callahan.

Well, that day, Dr. Callahan discovered the essence behind EFT, which is now referred to as the **Discovery Statement** – "The cause of all negative emotions is a disruption in the body's energy system."

So, let's break it down… What happened to Mary's water phobia?

When Mary was feeling or even talking about her fear, her stomach meridian and the energy flowing through it was disrupted. That disruption is what was causing her emotional intensity. By tapping under her eyes, it sent pulses through her stomach meridian and fixed it, balancing it out. Once the energy through the meridian was flowing, correctly the fear went away.

> *Therein lies the most powerful thing you are ever going to learn about your unwanted emotions. They are caused by energy disruptions!*
> — *Gary Craig*

Gary Craig Brought EFT to the World

Gary Craig, a Stanford engineer, gives much praise to the people that went before him as pioneers in this field. One of those people was Dr. Roger Callahan. Dr. Callahan developed Thought Field Therapy, and Gary Craig studied under him. Thought Field Therapy was developed more for the professional therapist or doctor to use on their patients. Gary Craig set out to bring these techniques to the layperson, as well as the professional, simplifying and streamlining these techniques for easy use and absolutely amazing results. He called it Emotional Freedom Technique (EFT). Gary Craig is the founder of EFT and has brought this amazing, beneficial technique to the world.

When Our Energy System Goes Haywire

A great example of our body's energy system is to compare it to that of a TV set. With a TV, even though you can't see the electricity, you know it's there. And you know the electricity is running correctly through the TV because you can clearly see the picture and clearly hear the sound. But imagine taking off the back of the TV set and poking around at it with a screwdriver (causing trauma) and rerouting the electrical flow. The picture and sound would become erratic, causing an electrical "zzzzt". The TV would be experiencing its own version of a negative emotion. Just like our body's energy system, when we have trauma and/or our energy system becomes disrupted, we essentially get an electrical "zzzzt" effect going on inside, and we have a negative emotion. Fix that "zzzzt" by tapping, just like fixing the wires on the back of the TV, and the negative emotion goes away. The concept is simple and easy.

The "Missing Link"

This "zzzzt" is a disruption in the body's energy system. It is this "zzzzt" that has been overlooked when dealing with the mind and the body. We have always known that when we have a distressing memory or thought, it results in a negative emotion (and even physical discomfort and pain). But they are discovering a "missing link," an intermediate step between the distressing thought and the negative emotion. It is a disruption in the body's energy system, a "zzzzt" effect going on inside.

	Step 1) Distressing memory or thought
Missing Link >	Step 2) "zzzzt" – Energy Disruption (Intermediate Step)
	Step 3) Negative emotion

With EFT, we can address this missing step. In just dealing with Step 1, we never address the *electrical charge*, that "zzzzt" going on inside. If we just concern ourselves with, and try to deal with, the distressing memory or thought or negative emotion, we miss Step 2. If we fix Step 2, the energy disruption, they can still have the memory or thought, but they won't be able to find the negative emotion tied to it. When we balance the energy disruption, the negative emotion goes away. When the "zzzzt" is gone, the trigger is gone. When this "zzzzt" is being addressed, we are truly dealing with the cause.

How to do EFT

“The Basic Recipe”

The Basic Recipe is a simple tapping procedure. We also call it “the 100% overhaul concept”. It is not necessary or practical to figure out which energy meridians are out of balance. So, instead of trying to discern which energy meridians are disrupted, we do the 100% overhaul, and then we know we’ve fixed it. The Basic Recipe overhauls the whole energy system, and is quick, efficient, and easy to memorize. So, at times, we may be tapping on meridian points that are not disrupted, and that’s okay; it won’t do any harm. At the same time, we are always getting to the meridians that do need to be balanced. You don’t have to know anything about the energy meridians except where these points are.

Before you tap, choose an issue and always get an intensity level from 0-10.

This Basic Recipe includes a few ingredients:

1. The Set-up
2. The Sequence (tapping points)
3. Reassessment of Intensity Level and Sequence again
4. The 9 Gamut Procedure (fine tuning)
5. Testing

Always, before you begin the Basic Recipe you need to find your **intensity level**. Zero being no pain or distress, and ten being extreme pain or distress. Five is what we consider moderate. With this system, we can evaluate the intensity level concerning a specific issue and monitor it as we use EFT. Rating your intensity level is subjective, so if you’re not sure what number you’re at, just guess what the number would be if you did know.

1. The Setup

Before we can clear any energy disruptions, we have to make sure our energy system is properly set up and, properly oriented. The “Setup” will do this for you, so always do it first. The reason being is that there is sometimes an electrical interference that can block the effectiveness of these Tapping Procedures. This interference in our energy system is what we call a *General Polarity Reversal* (GPR), where our energy is *cross-switched*. Similar to having batteries placed wrong in a flashlight, it just won’t work. Batteries have positive and negative ends, and they have to be aligned right. Similarly, if our polarity is reversed, you could use EFT all day long and even other healing methods and not have great results. The “Set-up” fixes this *General Polarity Reversal* and orients your energy to the issue at hand. Then, we can use the Tapping Procedure.

Note: Remember that *Polarity Reversals* are not the same as the Energy Disruptions within our meridians.

This ***General Polarity Reversal*** (GPR) is also referred to as **Psychological Reversal**. Again, it is important to note that it can hinder the healing process, whether using EFT or any other healing method. It is why some people just cannot change, heal, or overcome a chronic condition, lose weight, quit smoking, etc., and why they continue to sabotage themselves.

It only takes about 30 seconds to do the “Setup,” so everyone should do it, whether you think you need it or not. We’re still going by “The 100% overhaul” system.

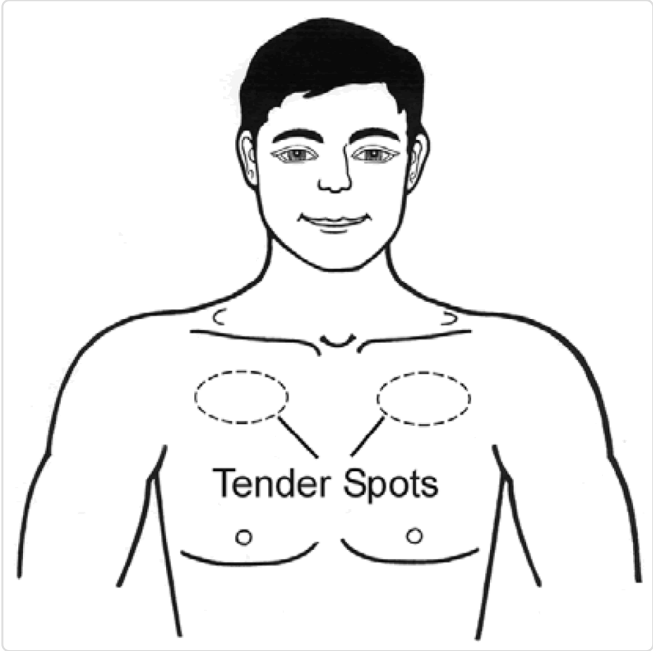
The Set-up Procedure: Repeat an affirmation 3 times while rubbing the “Tender Spots.” The affirmation is a neutralizing statement… a negative couched with a positive. It goes something like this:

“Even though I have this (issue), I deeply and completely love and accept myself.”

While repeating this statement 3 times out loud, rub your “Tender Spots” in small circular motions. The blank is where you insert the issue you’d like to work on. The “Tender Spots” are located on each side of the chest (about 3 inches down from the top of your sternum, and 3 inches to the left and right).

Rub the “Tender Spots” and say – for example:

- *“Even though I have this fear of flying,*
  I deeply and completely love and accept myself.”
- *“Even though I have this pain in my right foot,*
  I deeply and completely love and accept myself.”
- *“Even though I have this anger towards my*
  brother for embarrassing me at my wedding,
  I deeply and completely love and accept myself.”
- *Even though I have this chocolate craving,*
  I deeply and completely love and accept myself.”
- *“Even though I have this nervous stomach,*
  I deeply and completely love and accept myself.”
- *“Even though I have this sadness about my*
  mom’s condition,
  I deeply and completely love and accept myself.”
- *“Even though I have this fear of public speaking,*
  I deeply and completely love and accept myself.”



And the list goes on and on. You can use variations in these setup statements, such as the “chocolate craving” listed above. I find it is best to really describe how you are feeling and insert that into the Set-up Statement, i.e., *“Even though I really want to eat this chocolate*…” or *“Even though I’m really pissed at my brother for embarrassing me…”* Then, we use that underlined part as the reminder phrase while tapping the Sequence.

2. The Sequence

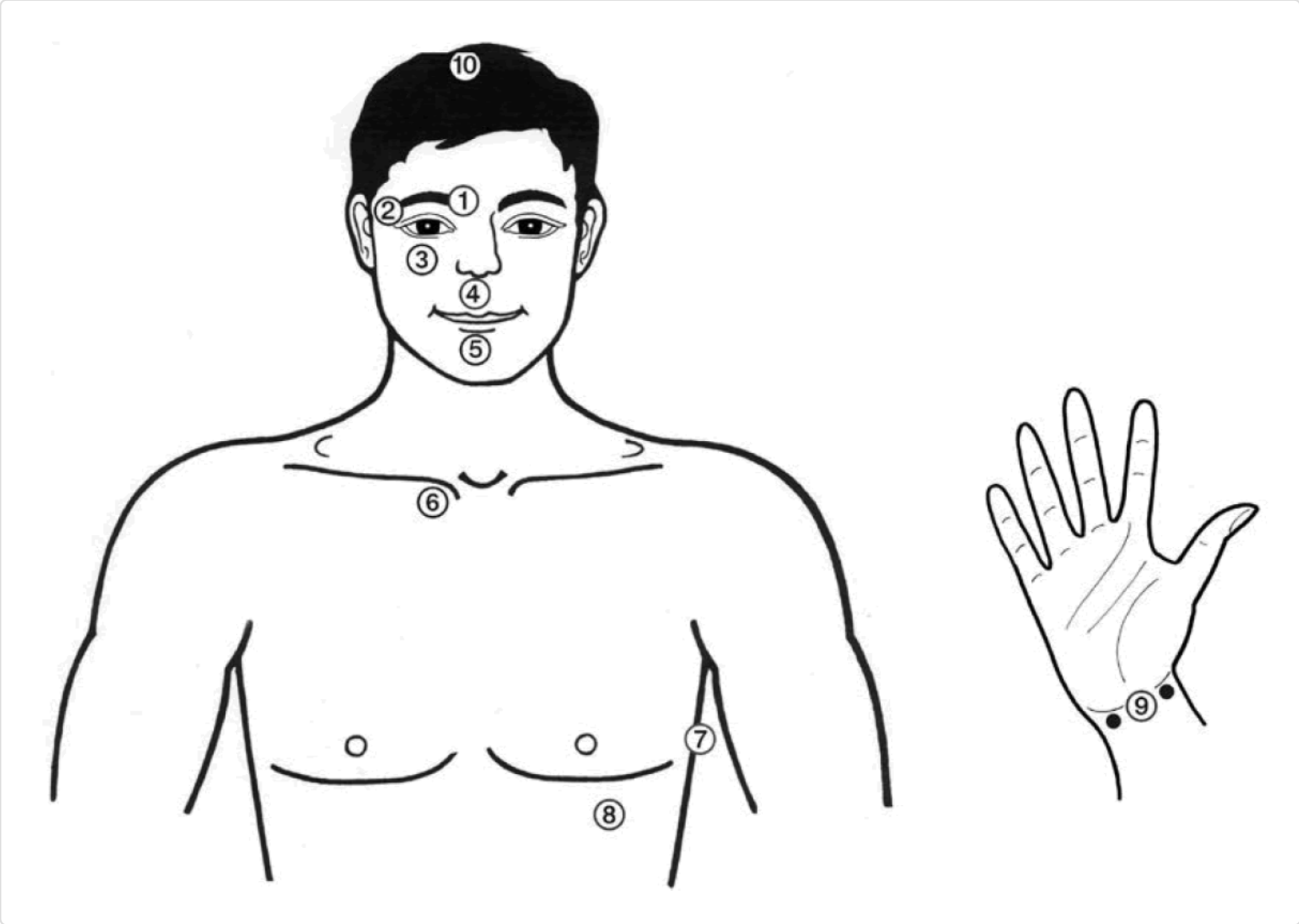
The tapping points are what we call the Sequence. These points are the “endpoints” of the body’s energy meridians. Tap each point 5 to 7 times each while saying your reminder phrase.

For example, say:

- *“My fear of flying”* **(on each point while tapping)**
- *“My chocolate craving”*
- *“The pain in my right foot”*
- *“Pissed at my brother for embarrassing me”*

Do this for a couple of rounds (sequences) on whatever problem you wish to address, always addressing one problem at a time.

The Sequence (Tapping Points)



3. Reassessment of Your Intensity Level and Continue Doing the Sequence (Tapping)

As we tap a few rounds, our intensity level usually comes down. So, reassess where you are at on a scale of 0 – 10. When the intensity level is down to about a 5, use a new Setup affirmation and continue to do subsequent rounds.

The new Setup affirmation goes something like this:

> *"Even though I **still** have **some** of this, I deeply and completely love and accept myself."*

This statement changes the intention of the affirmation towards the "remainder" of the problem. For example:

> *"Even though I **still** have **some** of this fear of flying, I deeply and completely love and accept myself."*

Then, continue doing the Sequence (rounds of tapping), using the **reminder phrase** saying: ***"remaining _____."*** – (insert problem)

> **For example, say: *"remaining** fear of flying"* – **(on each point)**

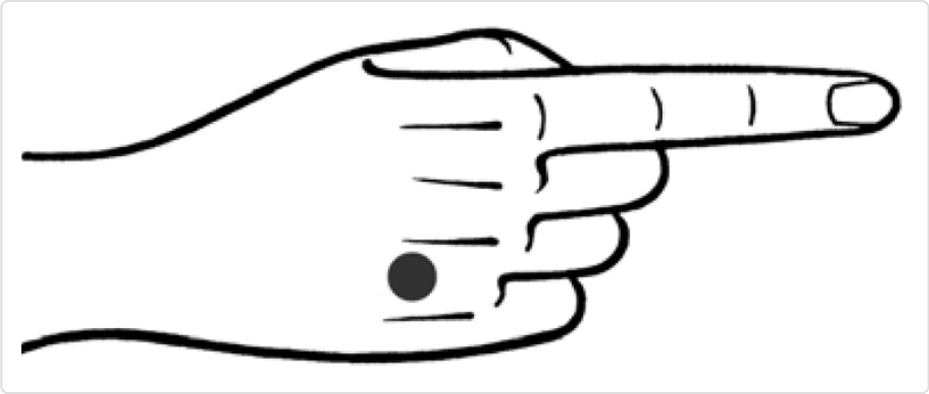
Continue doing the Sequence for as many rounds as it takes to get the Intensity Level to a zero or a one. If the Intensity Level seems to be stuck at a one, fine-tune the brain by using the 9 Gamut Procedure.

4. The 9 Gamut Procedure (Fine-Tuning the Brain)

The 9 Gamut Procedure is now used towards the end of the EFT process. In working with an issue, when the intensity level is down to a one or zero, we can use the 9 Gamut Procedure. If the intensity level is at a one, it can help bring the intensity level down to a zero. If it is already at a zero, it helps to lock in the work you've done. It helps the brain and the body to integrate the work that's been done and is almost like a "tune-up" for the brain. The 9 Gamut Procedure takes about 15 seconds to do. It has some eye movements, which stimulate parts of the brain via nerves that connect to the eyes. This procedure also has humming and counting to help balance the right and left-brain hemispheres. The humming engages the right (creative) side of the brain, while the counting engages the left (digital/logical) side of the brain. It fine-tunes the brain. I also refer to it as a "re-start button." Always use the 9 Gamut Procedure to fine-tune the brain and integrate all the work that you've done.

The Gamut Point is between the ring finger and the little finger, an inch back on top of the hand. You can use either hand.

Location of the Gamut Point



The 9 Gamut Procedure

While tapping on the Gamut Point continuously, you can repeat your reminder phrase and follow this procedure:

1. Eyes closed.
2. Eyes open.
3. Eyes hard down to the right while holding the head steady.
4. Eyes hard down to the left while holding the head steady.
5. Roll eyes in a big circle once, in one direction.
6. Roll eyes in a big circle once, in the other direction.
7. Hum 2 seconds of a song (happy birthday).
8. Count rapidly from 1 to 5.
9. Hum 2 seconds of a song again.

After doing this procedure, I'll sometimes end by doing another round of the Sequence, but this time tapping only on the positives.

5. Test Your Results

When the Intensity Level seems to be at a zero, test your results. Think about the issue or problem and try to bring up the negative emotional response. Think about it and really try to bring it up; try to bring up any trigger or charge on the issue. If you can't, then you're at a zero. If you can still feel any emotional pain around the issue, continue by doing the Sequence again and/or the 9-Point Gamut Procedure until it is at a zero. You are done. We also need to be aware of "aspects."

Emotional Freedom Technique Handouts

- The Basic Recipe
- The 9 Gamut Procedure

In Closing

EFT is technique that can be learned easily and quickly and is very effective. The key here is to learn the basics of EFT. But beyond the technique, it is an art form that needs to be practiced and your skills honed as you learn to work with yourself and others.

Sometimes, our issues are complex, so the more you learn, the more experience you'll have in being "a loving detective" and how to apply this simple technique for many different issues. You'll learn to work through any stumbling blocks even when EFT "appears" to not be working. Be persistent and intuitive, and practice EFT every day. This is a gentle yet powerful tool that can have life-changing results!

These are just the basics. For more in-depth study on how to become an EFT Practitioner, or incorporate it into your Hypnotherapy Practice, or just use it with friends and family, I also teach EFT seminars.

- Emotional Freedom Technique
- Advanced EFT

You can find further information about these courses through the American Hypnosis Association.

Continuing Education Opportunities

Suggested Reading

- EmoFree.com: Gary Craig’s Website (Founder of EFT)

Supplemental Videos

- American Hypnosis Association – Media Library

Recommended AHA Events Live on Zoom

1. EVE: Advanced Emotional Freedom Technique
2. EVE: Emotional Freedom Technique

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